

Parasitic STDs

Parasites are organisms that live on or in a host, which they use as a food source. They can cause disease in humans.

	Causes	Symptoms	Diagnosis	Treatment
Pubic lice	Pubic lice are transferred by close bodily contact, most commonly sexual contact. Lice crawl from hair to hair, but can't fly or jump.	It can take several weeks before symptoms appear. Symptoms include itching in infected areas; inflammation and irritation caused by scratching; black powder in underwear; or blue spots or small spots of blood appearing on the skin, caused by lice bites. Itching caused by pubic lice can lead to irritated skin or skin infections. If the eyelashes are infested, eye infections may occur.	Pubic lice are usually easy to diagnose. The doctor or nurse may use a magnifying glass to look for signs of the lice.	Pubic lice can be treated with cream, lotion, or shampoo at home, and by removing the hair from the infected area. The treatment varies depending on the infection.
Scabies	Tiny mites that burrow into the skin cause scabies. They are usually spread through long periods of skin or sexual contact.	One of the main symptoms is itching that gets worse at night, but can also lead to skin becoming inflamed and irritated, causing a secondary skin infection. Sometimes a skin rash is caused in areas where the mites have burrowed.	It can be diagnosed by looking for the mites' burrow marks, and by using ink to make the marks visible.	Scabies is treated with topical cream, which is applied to the whole body.
Trichomoniasis	Trichomoniasis is caused by a tiny parasite that mainly infects the vagina and urethra in females, and the urethra or occasionally head of the penis or prostate gland in males. It is usually spread by unprotected sex, or by sharing sex toys that aren't properly clean. It can also be passed through oral or anal sex, toilet seats, or by any naked contact.	Symptoms include abnormal vaginal discharge; thin, white discharge from the penis; soreness, inflammation, and itching around the vagina or the head of the penis; pain or discomfort when urinating, having sex, or ejaculating; or needing to urinate more frequently.	Trichomoniasis can be diagnosed by examining the genitals and with a laboratory test carried out on a swab taken from the genitals.	Most cases of trichomoniasis can be treated with an antibiotic, which is usually taken twice a day for five to seven days.
Vaginitis	It can be caused by infections, including thrush, bacterial infections, or parasitic infections; or by irritants.	Vaginitis is inflammation of the vagina that can cause itching, discomfort, and discharge. Symptoms include vaginal itching or unpleasant-smelling vaginal discharge; pain when urinating or having sex; and light bleeding, or spotting.	A doctor or nurse will examine or test based on symptoms.	Treatment depends on cause. Yeast infections are treated with antifungal medicines. Bacterial infections are treated with antibiotics.